



Pull Requests & Code Review

with GitHub Copilot

AI-powered reviews, PR summaries, and automated fixes

Copilot in the PR Workflow

Three AI-powered capabilities that transform how you create, review, and merge pull requests.



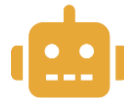
PR Summary

Auto-generate clear, concise pull request descriptions and titles from your code changes. Helps reviewers understand what changed and why.



Code Review

Copilot reviews your code and provides feedback with suggested fixes you can apply in a couple of clicks. Uses agentic architecture with full project context.



Automated Fixes

Copilot can pass review suggestions to the cloud agent, which creates a new PR with fixes applied — closing the review loop automatically.

PR Summary: Auto-Generated Descriptions

Copilot scans your code changes and generates a summary — a prose overview plus a bulleted list of key changes.

1

Create or Open a PR

On GitHub.com, create a new pull request or navigate to an existing one

2

Click the Copilot Icon

In the description field header, select the Copilot icon (🔮), then click Summary

3

Review the Summary

Copilot generates a prose overview + bulleted list of changes linked to code lines

4

Edit & Publish

Add any additional context, then click Create pull request or Update comment

Also Available:

PR Title Generation: Copilot button in the title field generates titles from commit messages.

Summary as Comment: Add summaries in the comment section of existing PRs, not just the description.

Copilot Code Review: How It Works

Copilot reviews your code from multiple angles — identifying issues, suggesting fixes, and understanding full project context.

Full Project Context

Copilot gathers context from your entire repository — reading related files, tracing cross-file dependencies, analyzing PR description and commit messages.

Multi-Angle Analysis

Checks correctness, security, readability, and performance.
Reviews code in any programming language.

Suggested Fixes

Where possible, includes suggested code changes you can apply with a couple of clicks — commit one fix or batch multiple together.

Auto-Fix via Cloud Agent

Copilot can pass suggestions to the cloud agent, which creates a new PR with fixes applied automatically — closing the review loop.

Code Review: Step by Step (GitHub)

1

Open Your PR

Create a pull request or navigate to an existing one on GitHub.com

2

Request Copilot Review

Open the Reviewers menu, then select Copilot from the list

3

Wait for Review

Copilot reviews your PR — usually takes less than 30 seconds

4

Read Comments

Scroll down and read Copilot's comments. It always leaves a "Comment" review (not Approve or Request Changes)

5

Apply Suggestions

Accept a single suggestion and commit, or batch multiple suggestions into one commit

6

Iterate

Add reactions, reply to comments, or resolve them — just like human review comments



Key: Copilot's reviews do NOT count toward required approvals. They won't block merging. Each review consumes 1 premium request from your quota.

Code Review in Your IDE

Review code before opening a PR — catch issues early in your development workflow.

VS Code

- Select the code you want reviewed
- Right-click → Generate Code → Review
- Comments appear in the Comments panel and inline in the editor
- Also works via Copilot Chat: ask "review this code" with #selection
- Uses custom instructions from .github/copilot-instructions.md

Visual Studio

- Requires Visual Studio 17.14 or later
- Works in the editor — select code and request review
- Same review quality as GitHub.com experience
- Custom instructions supported from base branch
- Review inline before pushing — shift left on quality



Shift Left: Review code in your IDE before opening a PR. Catch bugs, style issues, and security problems before they reach the review cycle.

Automatic Code Review Setup

Configure Copilot to automatically review every PR — no manual reviewer assignment needed.

For Yourself

Copilot Settings → Automatic Copilot code review → Enabled

Requires Copilot Pro or Pro+ plan

For a Repository

Repo Settings → Rules → Rulesets → New branch ruleset → Select target branches → Enable "Automatically request Copilot code review"

Available to repo admins

For an Organization

Org Settings → Copilot → Features → enable **Automatic Copilot code review**

Use patterns like `*feature` to match repo names



Review new pushes — review every push, not just the first



Review draft PRs — catch errors early, before human review

Reviewing a Copilot-Created PR

After Copilot creates a PR, you should review it thoroughly. Here's how to interact with it.

@copilot in Comments

Mention @copilot in PR comments to ask for changes. Copilot starts a new session, adds an 🗨️ reaction, and pushes commits directly to the branch.

Choose a Model

When submitting comments via the web UI, you can select a model using the model picker. By default, Copilot uses the model that created the PR.

Request Separate PR

Ask Copilot to create a separate PR for fixes instead of pushing to the current branch, using natural language in your comment.

Batch Your Feedback

Submit review comments together, not one at a time. Copilot responds to comments from people with write access to the repository.

Push Your Own Changes

You can check out Copilot's branch and make manual changes yourself. Mix human and AI contributions on the same PR.

Approval Rules Apply

Your approval of a Copilot PR won't count toward required approvals if you're the one who requested the review.

What Copilot Checks During Review

Correctness

Logic errors, off-by-one mistakes, null references, unhandled edge cases

Security

Vulnerabilities, injection risks, unsafe data handling, authentication gaps

Readability

Code clarity, naming conventions, complexity, maintainability

Performance

Inefficient patterns, unnecessary computations, resource leaks

Style & Standards

Formatting, consistency with project conventions, best practices

Cross-file Impact

How changes affect other files, dependencies, breaking changes



Limitations to Remember

Not guaranteed to catch all issues — always pair with human review. Model switching not supported — uses a tuned mix for consistency. Context is bounded by model window and time budget — very large PRs may get partial coverage.

Key Takeaways



PR Summary auto-generates descriptions and titles — saves time and gives reviewers better context.



Code Review uses agentic architecture with full project context — checks correctness, security, readability, performance, and style.



Apply suggested fixes in clicks — accept single fixes or batch multiple into one commit.



Automatic review via rulesets — configure at user, repo, or org level. Enable draft PR review for early feedback.



Cloud Agent can go from GitHub Issue → PR autonomously. Assign an issue to Copilot and it researches, codes, tests, and opens a PR.



Use @copilot in PR comments to ask for changes. Copilot pushes commits directly to the branch.



Custom instructions in .github/copilot-instructions.md let you enforce team standards in every review.



Always pair Copilot review with human review — Copilot supplements, it doesn't replace human judgment.